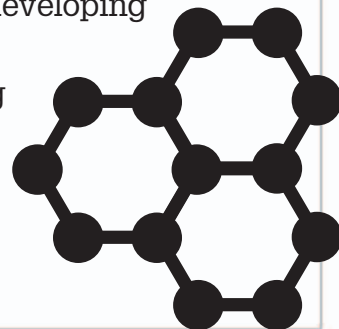




BIOTECHNOLOGIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

At the cutting edge of science, biotechnologists use their knowledge of how living organisms function to find solutions to problems and develop new products. Their work includes developing new vaccines against diseases, improving animal feed, growing crops that are more resistant to drought and pests, and improving everyday products, such as cheese and bread.



SALARY

Biotechnologist ★★★★★

Senior biotechnologist ★★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Many global opportunities •
Wide range of potential employers •
Best job prospects in industrial and medical specialty areas

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Laboratory work • Scientific investigation • Biology • Chemistry • Physics • Mathematics • Engineering



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree or graduate qualification in a biological- or chemical-related discipline is required for this career.



LIFESTYLE Work hours are regular, but biotechnologists may have to work in the evenings, on weekends, or in shifts to check on research experiments.



LOCATION For the most part, biotechnologists of all levels work in sterilized laboratories in research or industrial buildings.



THE REALITIES Ground-breaking discoveries can be exciting, but the work can also be repetitive and frustrating. Many hours are spent in the laboratory.

RELATED CAREERS

► **MICROBIOLOGIST** *see pp. 138–139*

► **FOOD SCIENTIST** *see pp. 142–143*

► **CHEMICAL ENGINEER** *see pp. 180–181*

► **BIOCHEMIST** Conducts scientific research into chemical reactions that take place in living organisms. Biochemists analyze the effects of drugs, foods, allergies, and disease on cells, proteins, and DNA.

► **BIOMEDICAL RESEARCH SCIENTIST** Performs clinical trials and lab tests to research methods of treating disease and other health-related conditions.

In the United States, the biopharmaceutical industry grew by more than 40 percent between 2002 and 2011.